

Choosing the Right AI Assistant

Today you will learn which AI tool is usually good for which kind of work, compare outputs, and design your first role-specific AI assistant.

Tool choice

Live comparison

Scenario games

Custom GPTs and Gems

Simple idea

Do not ask, "Which AI is best?" Ask, "Best for this task, this file, this audience, and this workflow?"

Today: choose, compare, build, test

Your output: one assistant blueprint

A practical session for mixed learners.

Some people may be teachers, some office staff, some students, some business owners. Everyone will choose a path that fits their real work.

1. Understand

Learn the simple strengths of ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Copilot, GPTs, and Gems.

2. Compare

Run the same task in two tools and discuss what changed.

3. Build

Design a role assistant and test it with five prompts.

The same prompt can feel different in different assistants.

One tool may give a fast list. Another may write a longer polished draft. Another may connect better with your Google or Microsoft files.

I need a quick idea

I need a long document

I need help inside Docs or Word

I repeat this task weekly

Click the situation closest to your work.

Layman rule

A tool is like a helper with a habit. Learn the habit, then choose the helper that fits the job.

● ● ● ONE-MINUTE DECISION RULE

What do I need?

Idea, email, table, report, code, slide, analysis, or assistant?

Where is my work?

Chat, Google Docs, Microsoft Word, PDF, spreadsheet, or browser?

How deep is it?

Quick answer, long document, many files, or repeat workflow?

What is sensitive?

Private records, student data, company files, names, IDs, or passwords?

Start with the main assistant families.

Assistant	Usually strong for	Simple example	Watch out
ChatGPT	General productivity, brainstorming, writing, files, images, data-style thinking.	Create a plan, rewrite a notice, analyze a small table, draft slides.	Still verify important facts and privacy.
Claude	Long-form writing, careful rewriting, document reasoning, structured explanations.	Improve a long policy draft or compare two long texts.	May be more detailed than needed; ask for short outputs.
Gemini	Google-style workflows, everyday research support, Docs/Gmail/Drive-friendly tasks.	Plan a class activity from a Google Doc or create Gmail-style text.	Check account and workspace settings.
Copilot	Microsoft work: Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook, Teams, SharePoint.	Summarize meeting notes, draft Word content, explain Excel data.	Best when your work is already in Microsoft 365.

ChatGPT is a strong all-purpose starting point.

Use it when you do not know where to start, need a fast draft, want multiple options, or need help thinking through a task.

Productivity

Plans, checklists, schedules, emails, meeting notes.

Creative work

Names, captions, poster copy, lesson ideas, campaign ideas.

Mixed tasks

Analyze a file, explain a topic, create a table, draft slides.

Try this prompt

I am a beginner teacher. Give me 5 practical ways AI can save me 30 minutes this week. Use a table with task, AI help, and what I must check.

Claude is often useful for longer writing and careful editing.

Use it when the task needs reading, rewriting, structured thinking, or a more polished long response.

Long documents

Reports, policy drafts, SOPs, proposals, manuals.

Careful rewrite

Make text clearer, warmer, shorter, or more professional.

Thoughtful review

Find gaps, contradictions, weak logic, or missing sections.

Try this prompt

Review this draft report for clarity, structure, and missing points. Give 3 strengths, 5 improvements, and a revised outline before rewriting.

Gemini is useful when your work lives in Google.

Use it for Google-style tasks, quick research support, Gmail/Docs thinking, and Gemini Gems for repeated goals.

Google workflow

Docs, Gmail, Drive-style planning, classroom material, summaries.

Everyday help

Plan activities, explain topics, organize ideas, draft messages.

Gems

Create a reusable mini-assistant for a repeated need.

Try this prompt

Help me turn these rough notes into a Google Docs-style meeting summary with headings, action items, and a short follow-up email.

Copilot is strongest when your work is inside Microsoft 365.

Use it when you already work in Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook, Teams, or SharePoint.

Word and Outlook

Draft, rewrite, summarize, polish tone, create responses.

Excel and data

Ask questions about tables, trends, charts, and summaries.

Meetings and slides

Summaries, action items, PowerPoint outlines, speaker notes.

Try this prompt

Summarize this meeting into decisions, action items, owners, deadlines, and one short email I can send to the team.

A custom assistant is a saved helper for a repeated job.

Instead of rewriting the same long prompt every time, you save instructions once. Then the assistant follows those instructions whenever you use it.

Reusable

Role-specific

No-code

Needs testing

Simple examples

- Teacher Assistant for lesson plans and quizzes
- Report Writer for office summaries
- Parent Notice Helper for school messages
- Social Media Caption Coach for a small business

● ● ● WHAT TO PUT INSIDE

Purpose

What job should this assistant do again and again?

Behavior

How should it respond? Ask questions, give tables, be brief?

Knowledge

What documents, rules, examples, or style notes should guide it?

Boundaries

What should it never do? Private data, final grading, legal claims?

Purpose + behavior + knowledge + boundaries

Slide 11

Which assistant would you try first?

Click a scenario. Discuss why that choice might be useful. There can be more than one reasonable answer.

Improve a Word report

Draft a Gmail message

Review a long policy

Repeat a weekly task

Click one scenario.

Discussion prompt

What information would you need before choosing the tool? File type? Privacy? Desired output? Account access? Deadline?

AI Tool Match Challenge

Twelve real-world cases. Pick the assistant you would try first and read why. Play as individuals, pairs, or whole-room voting.

12 scenarios

Tool reasoning

Beginner-friendly

Start challenge

Rank guide

0-59: Tool Explorer

60-99: Tool Chooser

100+: AI Matchmaker

Best score: **0**

Compare two assistants on the same task.

Do not only ask, "Which answer is longer?" Ask which one is more useful for the job.

1. Same prompt

Use identical wording in two tools.

2. Same output target

Email, table, report, quiz, or plan.

3. Compare quality

Clarity, usefulness, detail, tone, safety.

4. Improve

Use follow-up prompts in both tools.

Demo prompt

Create a one-page plan for a school AI awareness session for beginner teachers. Include objectives, activities, time plan, materials, and what teachers must check before using AI.

Use a simple scorecard instead of guessing.

Check	Question to ask	Score 1-5
Clarity	Can a beginner understand it in one reading?	1 2 3 4 5
Usefulness	Can I use this output with small edits?	1 2 3 4 5
Format	Did it follow the requested structure?	1 2 3 4 5
Safety	Did it avoid risky advice or private data problems?	1 2 3 4 5
Local fit	Does it match our school, office, audience, or context?	1 2 3 4 5

Everyone chooses a path that fits their real life.

Teacher Track

Build a Teacher Assistant for lesson plans, quizzes, rubrics, and student-friendly explanations.

Office Track

Build a Report Writer for emails, meeting summaries, action items, notices, and SOP drafts.

Business Track

Build a Customer Message Helper for replies, offers, product descriptions, and follow-ups.

Student Track

Build a Study Coach for summaries, flashcards, practice questions, and simple explanations.

Creator Track

Build a Content Helper for captions, posters, video scripts, and campaign ideas.

Admin Track

Build an Organizer for schedules, checklists, forms, and announcement drafts.

Choose your learner track.

TRACK

Teacher



Show my activity

Your suggested hands-on work

Teacher Assistant

Build: Create an assistant that makes lesson plans, quizzes, rubrics, worksheets, and student-friendly explanations.

Five test prompts:

1. Create a 45-minute lesson plan
2. Make 10 quiz questions
3. Explain a hard concept simply
4. Create a marking rubric
5. Rewrite a notice to parents

Safety reminder: Do not share real student names, marks, IDs, or private records.

Design your GPT or Gem.

NAME

Teacher Assistant

PURPOSE

help me create lesson plans, quizzes

AUDIENCE

beginner teachers and Grade 8 students

TONE

simple, supportive, and practical

FORMAT RULES

Use tables when helpful. Give short examples. Ask clarifying questions if the task is unclear.

SAFETY RULES

Do not ask for private student data. Remind me to review facts and adapt output to my local classroom.

Generated instructions

Name: Teacher Assistant

Purpose: You help me help me create lesson plans, quizzes, and rubrics.

Audience: Your responses are for beginner teachers and Grade 8 students.

Tone: Use a simple, supportive, and practical tone.

Behavior and format rules:

Use tables when helpful. Give short examples. Ask clarifying questions if the task is unclear.

Safety and boundaries:

Do not ask for private student data. Remind me to review facts and adapt output to my local classroom.

When a task is unclear, ask up to 3 questions before answering.

Copy instructions

Reset

● ● ● TEST WITH FIVE REAL PROMPTS

Do not trust a custom assistant until you test it.

Write five real prompts for your assistant. Test, observe, and refine the instructions.

Save

Copy tests

Clear

Your test prompts stay in this browser after saving.

1

1. Example: Create a 45-minute lesson plan for Grade 8 science

2

2. Example: Create a 45-minute lesson plan for Grade 8 science

3

3. Example: Create a 45-minute lesson plan for Grade 8 science

4

4. Example: Create a 45-minute lesson plan for Grade 8 science

5

5. Example: Create a 45-minute lesson plan for Grade 8 science

● ● ● IMPROVE THE ASSISTANT

Test

Ask one real prompt from your work.

Observe

What did it do well? What was missing?

Edit

Add clearer instructions, examples, or boundaries.

Retest

Try the same prompt again and compare.

Useful follow-up: "Based on this weak output, what instruction should I add to my custom assistant so it performs better next time?"

Before sharing a custom assistant, check what is inside.

A GPT or Gem can contain instructions, examples, uploaded files, and behavior rules. Some of that may be private or unsuitable for sharing.

Remove private data

No student names, IDs, marks, salaries, or confidential files.

Check instructions

Do not include passwords, hidden policies, or sensitive internal details.

Share carefully

Private, link, workspace, or public settings may behave differently.

Review outputs

The assistant still needs human review every time.

A simple activity flow for mixed beginners.

Time	Activity	What learners do	Your role
10 min	Tool choice warm-up	Vote on scenarios and explain choices.	Normalize different answers.
25 min	Tool map walkthrough	Write one task under each assistant.	Give simple examples, avoid jargon.
35 min	Compare two assistants	Score outputs with the scorecard.	Help them judge usefulness, not length.
55 min	Build assistant blueprint	Choose track, write purpose, rules, and safety boundaries.	Coach one-on-one by role.
35 min	Test with 5 prompts	Run prompts, note what worked and what failed.	Help refine instructions.
15 min	Share back	Show assistant name, purpose, one test result.	Give 2 strengths and 1 next step.

You now have a tool-choice habit and an assistant blueprint.

Choose by task, compare outputs, build for repeated work, test with real prompts, and keep private information out of shared assistants.

Celebrate completion

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Homework before Day 4

1. Finalize your Custom GPT or Gem blueprint.
2. Test it with 5 real prompts from your work or study.
3. Bring one good result and one weak result for discussion.
4. Write one sentence: "This assistant saves me time by..."

Career tip: Role-specific AI assistants are sellable. Schools, offices, and small businesses pay for helpers that save repeated work.